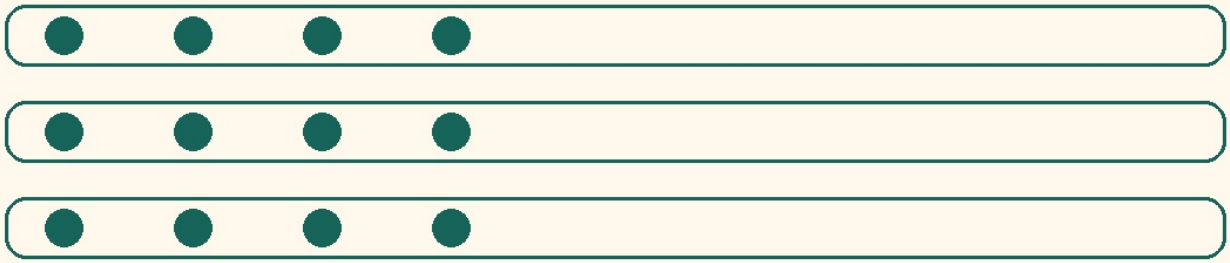




Three equal rows

Count four stones in each row.



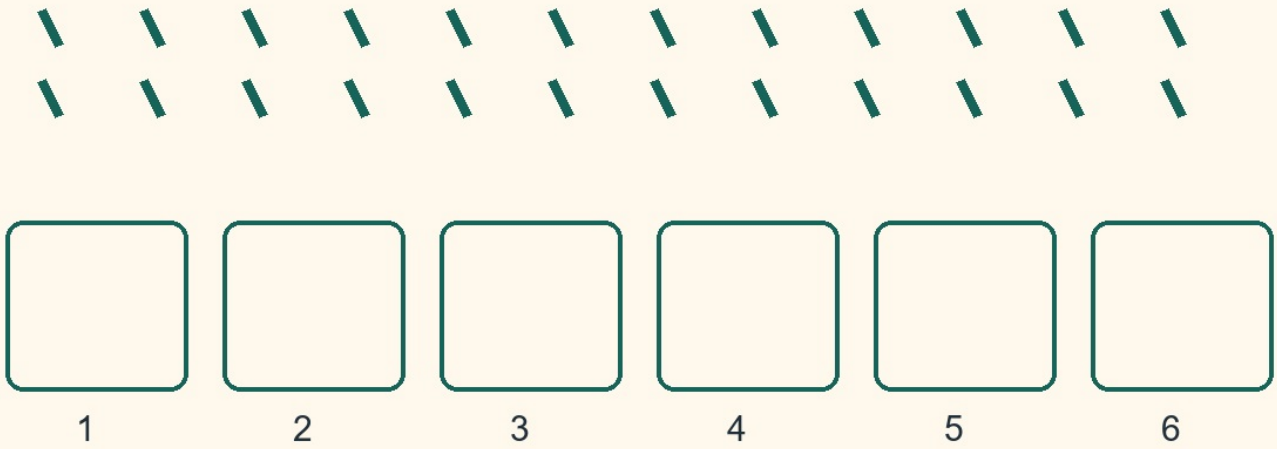
Page 1 of 4 · The Stones Turn Sideways

Hop-Tart reaches the pond as the first raindrops dimple the water. A fast current has spun every stepping stone sideways. Hop could leap across alone, but Centi-Peed needs a path with small, even gaps. Together they find three rows with four safe stones in each.



Share the reed ties

Share all 24 ties between six sections.



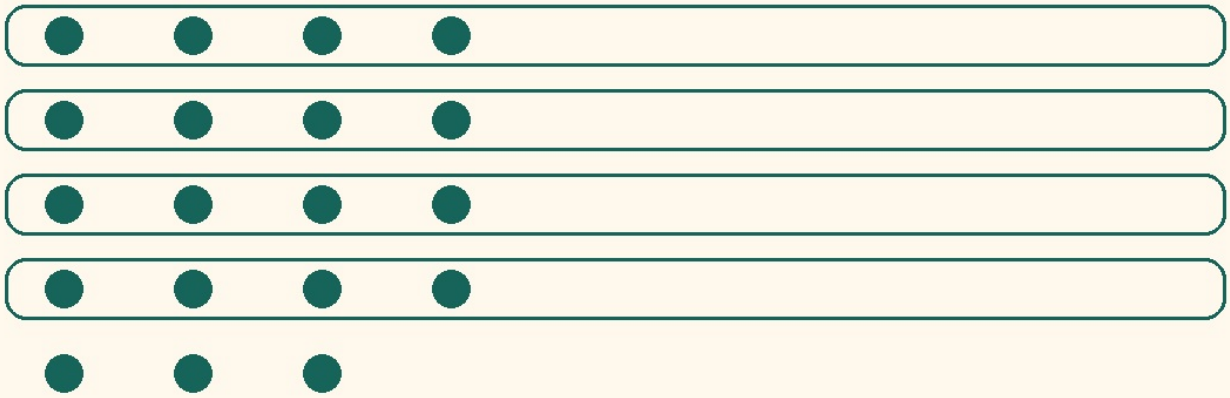
Page 2 of 4 · Reeds for Every Rail

The stones are steady, but Centi-Peed’s many little feet need handrails. Flutter-Butter brings 24 strong reed ties. The friends share them equally across six short bridge sections, checking that no section is wobblier than another.



Groups and spare seeds

Each complete group needs four seeds.



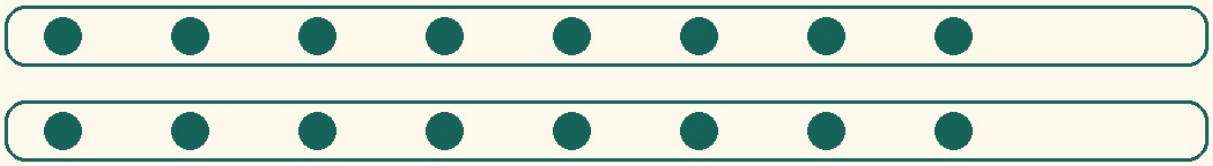
Page 3 of 4 · The Three Spare Glow-Seeds

Centi-Peed counts 19 glow-seeds for marking the route. Four seeds fit neatly around each landing stone. After four complete groups, three seeds remain. Hop-Tart starts to call them leftovers, then notices the darkest bend in the path.



Two equal groups

Count eight markers in each group.



Page 4 of 4 · A Path That Waits

The three spare seeds light the difficult bend, and two final groups of eight markers glow along the bank. Hop-Tart slows his biggest bounce to match Centi-Peed’s careful steps. They reach shelter together—not by making the fastest path, but by making one that waits for everyone.

Questions for Hop-Tart and the Stepping-Stone Switch

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · The Stones Turn Sideways

How many safe stones are in 3 rows of 4?

Choices: 7 · 10 · 12 · 16

Page 2 · Reeds for Every Rail

How many reed ties belong on each of the 6 sections?

Choices: 3 · 4 · 6 · 8

Page 3 · The Three Spare Glow-Seeds

How many complete groups of 4 can they make from 19 seeds?

Choices: 3 · 4 · 5 · 7

Page 4 · A Path That Waits

How many markers are in 2 groups of 8?

Choices: 10 · 14 · 16 · 18

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 12. Three equal rows of 4 make 4 + 4 + 4 = 12, so 3 x 4 = 12.

Page 2: 4. Share 24 into 6 equal groups. Since 6 x 4 = 24, each section gets 4 ties.

Page 3: 4. Four groups use 4 x 4 = 16 seeds. Three remain, so 19 ÷ 4 makes 4 complete groups with remainder 3.

Page 4: 16. Double 8 to find two equal groups: 8 + 8 = 16.

Free to read online and print: snackpackuniverse.com/read